

PS50008A Textbook

Research Methods & Experimental Design

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1 Welcome

This textbook accompanies PS50008A Research Methods & Experimental Design at Goldsmiths, University of London. It contains all lecture and lab readings organised by week, along with self-assessment quizzes to check your understanding.

2 How to Use This Textbook

Each week has **two readings** to complete:

1. **Lecture reading** — Read before or after Wednesday's lecture to reinforce the concepts
2. **Lab reading** — Read before Thursday's lab to prepare for practical exercises

After each week, test your understanding with the self-assessment quiz. These match the style of the MCQ exam.

PDF Downloads

Each chapter and quiz can be downloaded as a PDF for offline reading. Look for the PDF link at the top of each page.

3 Weekly Readings

Week	Lecture Reading	Lab Reading	Quiz
11	Introduction to Research	DataLab Foundations	Week 11 Quiz
12	Research Design Framework	Introduction to R	Week 12 Quiz
13	Building Your Research	Research Plan Workshop	Week 13 Quiz
14	Inference & t-tests	t-tests in R	Week 14 Quiz

Week	Lecture Reading	Lab Reading	Quiz
15	Correlation	Correlation in R	Week 15 Quiz
—	<i>Reading Week</i>	<i>Research Plan work</i>	—
16	APA Report Writing	Group Formation & Topic Selection	Week 16 Quiz
17	MCQ & EDS Preparation	Project Toolkit Phase 1	Week 17 Quiz
18	MCQ Exam Prep	Project Groups	Week 18 Quiz
19	Project Workshop	Data Collection	Week 19 Quiz
20	Wrapping Up	Report Writing	Week 20 Quiz

! Week 12 is Critical

Week 12 introduces ALL the terminology you need for your Research Plan: IV, DV, design types, hypothesis types, test selection, and descriptive statistics.

4 Assessment Deadlines

Week	Assessment
16	Research Plan due Fri 27 Feb (20%)
18	MCQ Exam Wed 11 Mar (20%)
19	EDS Assignment due Fri 20 Mar (20%)
Post-term	Research Report due 1 May 2026 (40%)

5 Quick Reference

- Assessment Overview
- Resources
- Data Dictionary
- Schedule